



English 2 Honors

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 10 · FULL YEAR

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Rooted in the classical tradition, English 2 Honors invites scholars into the great conversations of literature: enduring questions about virtue, power, identity, justice, and truth. The year moves from canonical short stories through medieval legend, ancient epic, and poetry to Shakespearean tragedy and the great American novel. Scholars practice grammar, logic, and rhetoric in writing across genres; engage in Socratic dialogue and debate; and reflect on the virtues and vices literature puts before them. Honors scholars take on greater text complexity and more independent analysis.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Q1 Short Story Foundations (Weeks 1–9)

Ten canonical short stories, from Poe and O. Henry to Amy Tan and Eugenia Collier: literary elements, character, and craft.

Q3 Epic, Heroes, and Poetry (Weeks 19–27)

A timed argumentative-writing intensive, then the hero's journey through epic (The Odyssey) and a poetry workshop: scholars analyze Whitman, Poe, and Herrick, and write their own haiku, sonnets, and free verse.

Q2 The Medieval Imagination (Weeks 10–18)

Excerpts from *The Once and Future King*, medieval satire and allegory, Robert Frost, and nonfiction on persuasion and medieval culture.

Q4 Tragedy and the American Dream (Weeks 28–37)

Shakespeare (*Julius Caesar*) and *The Great Gatsby*, with Socratic seminars, VR scenes such as *Gatsby's* party, a unit test, and a final analysis essay.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- A daily rhythm scholars can count on: grammar Monday, literary-term Tuesday, vocabulary Wednesday, quickwrite Thursday.
- Friday runs asynchronously as a flex day for catch-up, reflection, and extra help.
- Reading and discussion of the current text run all week, with VR discussions, builds, and performances on Optima's VR campus woven in.
- A weekly performance grade rewards steady participation.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Daily lesson, reading, and written work fill most of the scheduled time.
- Essay and project weeks (quarter ends) may run longer as drafts become final work.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Physical or digital copies of the core texts (several are provided inside the course).
- A writing journal or notebook, pens, highlighters, and notecards for vocabulary and research.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas; access to Optima's VR campus.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for essays and projects.

Grading at a glance: Assessments and Writing 35% · Homework and Classwork 30% · Projects 20% · Performance and Participation 15%

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.